

DESIGNING A DIVORCE

Gotham, the typeface is one that's beloved by the industry, second in popularity only to the overused Helvetica. The pair of designers behind the typeface were in high demand. Everything seemed great, until one designer sued the other – for \$20 million no less.

<http://dgit.in/wvFonts>

AMAZON = :-{ ?

Amazon is probably the world's most adored shopping sites. The insides of this great ship, however, tell a completely different story – one of discontent, unhappiness among its employees and a very poor work-life balance. A tell-all.

<http://dgit.in/wvAmazon>

MAKING GUNS COOL

Kids these days aren't really playing with toys; preferring their entertainment through mobile apps instead. Mattel, three years ago, embarked on a quest to build toy gun that kids would love to use. The story of the hurdles it faced is a thrilling read.

<http://dgit.in/wvToys>

THE MONA LISA IS BEAUTIFUL... RIGHT?

When a work of art is deemed 'beautiful' by a team of experts, people take their word for the truth and stop thinking about it for themselves. Take the Mona Lisa, for instance. Ian Leslie examines this psychological phenomena of art appreciation.

<http://dgit.in/wvMonaLisa>

global market,” adds Mr. Ranjan Sharma, Director Technical & Commercial, ZTE Telecom India.

Speaking of smartphones, right now there are very few smartphones that support LTE. 4G adoption is likely to get another boost from the low-cost/budget smartphones supporting the network. Smartphones bundled with data plans can also help drive LTE adoption.

Quality of service

The Indian telecom operators have always struggled to deliver quality. Not that they aren't making efforts, but catering to such a huge customer-base hasn't been easy. Data coverage has a lot of (arguably) discrepancy across the country. There have been some improvements over the years, though operators need to improve the existing 2G and 3G coverage and services along with the deployment of the new 4G network.

Moreover, LTE is set to create “data avalanche” as customers are expected to consume heavy data content such as videos, games and stream content. Operators need to brace up to deliver hassle-free services to customers.

Applications / Content

As in the case with 3G, customers tend to consume more content online if given faster and smoother data network. There's been a significant growth in consumption of videos, especially on the mobile platform.

According to a recent survey conducted by Vuclip, about 62% of Indian respondents prefer to view movies or TV serials instead of short movie clips on their phones. At 79%, this preference for long form content is extremely high among the age group of 18 years and under. Additionally, 89% of all respondents say they would watch their favorite movie on their

mobile phones if it was made available. If divided further by gender, 90% of male respondents and 84% of female respondents from India say that they would view their favorite film via mobile.

With 4G, consumption of online videos is likely to grow. Moreover, streaming of HD videos (and perhaps 4K content as well) is going to put a huge stress on the LTE network – for which telcos need to be prepared.

Ericsson India in its outlook for India's broadband segment points out that every app has its own requirements depending on the network performance. Operators can customize or prioritize the consumer's experience for certain apps.



Through techniques such as deep packet inspection and policy control, the network is able to identify which app is demanding more data throughput. Coupled with data plans that are ideal for certain apps – say for instance you care more about video streaming than IM apps – the network could in theory, customize the experience

for you. In other words “App Coverage” aims at delivering sufficient performance to run an application at acceptable quality.

Enterprise adoption

In addition to general usage, LTE adoption heavily banks on adoption by the enterprise market. With offices and businesses, especially the SMBs, embracing the newer and faster network, LTE will see a larger mass adoption.

Moreover, more and more organisations allowing remote working through BYOD, employees are increasingly dependent on their smartphone Internet connection to work while out of the office. The better speed of 4G can help them do more and faster.

LTE to go rural

LTE cannot remain niche for too long. It has to be accessible by all. We expect telcos to initially focus on the metro and urban cities, but sooner or later it has to reach the rural consumers, considering growing data consumption in tier 2 and tier 3 cities. However, telcos are still in the middle of making efforts to make 3G available to the masses. It will be interesting to see how telcos make that quick jump from 2G to 4G in the rural segment.

That said, the telecom industry seems very optimistic about the deployment of 4G in India. However, the major part of a successful adoption will depend on right strategy and implementation. Undoubtedly, 4G has massive potential and could be a key driver to India's growth in the IT and telecommunications sectors. 

What do you think about 4G? Do you think it's high time telcos should make 4G available across the country? Let us know your views by writing to editor@thinkdigit.com